

JAMES CHRISTOPHER FLETCHER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Engineer with 10 years of experience building and scaling backend systems that serve millions of users across fintech and SaaS platforms. I've led teams through major architectural migrations, established engineering practices that stuck, and mentored dozens of engineers from junior to senior level. I genuinely enjoy solving hard distributed systems problems and helping organisations move faster without breaking things.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

TechVault Solutions

techvault.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led the platform engineering team through a complete microservices migration from a monolithic Rails application, reducing deployment times from 45 minutes to 8 minutes and improving system reliability to 99.95% uptime.

Architected and implemented a new event streaming infrastructure using Kafka that now handles 500k events per second across multiple data centres. Established coding standards, code review practices, and architectural decision records that have significantly reduced post-deployment incidents across all teams. Mentored 4 junior engineers to mid-level positions and created a structured onboarding programme that reduced time-to-productivity for new hires from 8 weeks to 4 weeks.

Senior Software Engineer

Meridian Financial Group

meridianfintech.co

London, United Kingdom

June 2019 - February 2022

Designed and built a real-time transaction processing system in Go that handled 50,000 transactions per second with sub-100ms latency, critical for our FX trading platform serving institutional clients. Owned the infrastructure modernisation project which moved from bare metal servers to Kubernetes, reducing infrastructure costs by 35% while improving deployment frequency from monthly to hourly releases. Led incident response for P1 outages and implemented observability improvements including distributed tracing and custom metrics that reduced mean time to resolution by 40%. Collaborated with product and data teams to build a feature flagging system that enabled progressive rollouts and A/B testing across our platform.

Software Engineer

CloudBridge Technologies

cloudbridge.net

Manchester, United Kingdom

August 2014 - May 2019

Built backend APIs and services using Java and Python that powered mobile applications for 2 million active users, focusing on performance and reliability under high load. Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting

systems using Prometheus and ELK stack that provided real-time visibility into application health and reduced debugging time significantly. Contributed to the company's open source initiative by publishing 3 libraries that were adopted by other teams and external organisations. Developed and delivered training sessions on distributed systems concepts and cloud architecture patterns to engineering teams of 15-20 people.

EDUCATION

University of Manchester

BSc Computer Science with Honours (2:1)

Graduated June 2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, Bash

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Prometheus

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Cassandra

Message Queues: Kafka, RabbitMQ

System Design: Microservices, Event-driven Architecture, Distributed Systems

Tools and Platforms: Git, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, DataDog, ELK Stack